

Walking the Plank

A Few

Completely
Awesome
Activities



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Plank Setup

Watch videos, tips, suggestions and more online at www.TeamBuildingActivity.com.

Materials in Walk the Plank Kit

- 4, 7' Wood Planks
- 10 Rubber Rounds
- 8 Wooden Blocks
- 8 Wood 3" Safety Dowels
- 10 Mouse Pads
- 1 7' Wood Dowel
- 15 Eyeshades

Wood Planks

The 7 foot 'planks', or wooden boards, are all made from dense wood and are very heavy and durable. Because they are wood, these 'planks' or wood boards may be slightly warped, which is completely normal. When you put them in the blocks and people stand on them, they straighten out.

It can be challenging to put the boards into the wood blocks if the plank is warped. Simply pick up the wood, turn the block and it will fit in just fine.

Test the holes with your dowels immediately. They should fit fairly tight to a slightly loose.

Wood Blocks

The wood blocks are designed to elevate the planks and/or hold the planks in place during use.

- Splits - The blocks may be split in places as this is real wood. This is normal and do not worry. However, if the block splits too far or in an unsafe fashion, call us immediately and we will ship out a new one to you.
- Slots - The slots in the wood have all been tested with the planks to ensure they fit. If the plank is warped, you may need to angle the block slightly to make it fit. This is fine and the board will straighten out when weight is put upon it.
- Dowel Holes - Test your dowels with the holes to ensure they will work. They should fit fairly tight to slightly loose.

Rubber Rounds

The rounds are there for additional safety to prevent the wood blocks from moving, especially on a slick surface like a gym floor. The critical factors for the rubber rounds:

- Whenever you are using the wood blocks, be sure to use the rubber rounds underneath them. They are very tacky and will help the blocks stay in place while you are using them.
- There will be some instances in which the rubber rounds will not be beneficial. Use your common sense.
- If the rounds stop being tacky, wash them with gentle soap and they will become tacky again.

We have provided 10 rubber rounds. You only need 8 at any one time, but we wanted to give you two extra in case you need them. Safety is #1!

Wood Safety Dowels

- These dowels are made to go into the planks and/or into the wooden blocks to hold the planks in place.
- Check the dowels from time to time for cracking.
- The dowels may be snug and sometimes even difficult to pull out. This is a **GOOD THING**. We do not want them super loose as they may fall out during use.

Setup

It is critical to set up the planks correctly using the rubber rounds, wood blocks and safety dowels. Take your time and set these up prior to your first time using them so you know what to do before you are onsite.

Learn to set these up properly as this kit requires you to use one or another of these in almost every activity.

2" Planks Up

This means that the narrow side of the 7' plank is up. So a person will be walking and balancing on the 2" side - can be very challenging!

1. To set this up, place the 7' plank into the slot in the wood block with the 2" side facing up.
2. Slide the plank so the hole pushes past the slot in the wood.
3. Place 3" safety dowel into hole in plank.
4. Repeat on the other end of the plank.



6" Planks Up

1. Lay the wood block on it's side with the dowel hole facing up.
2. Place the plank on the block with the 6" side up.
3. Line up the dowel holes.
4. Place dowel into both holes.
5. Repeat on other end of plank.
6. Use support in the middle of the planks with additional wood blocks to prevent bowing and/or damage to the planks.



All Aboard

Watch videos, tips, suggestions and more online at www.TeamBuildingActivity.com.

Objective

All group members are to stand on the platform long enough to count to 10. Begin with the largest version of the platform and move to the smallest.

This is a group activity that involves increasing trust through proximity.

Materials

The materials you need are included in your kit:

- 2 to 8 wood blocks
- Safety webbing

Storyline

Climate change is affecting everyone, including your team. You were all on an amazing sailing adventure when your ship hit an iceberg and you all jumped onto some floating ice. However, it is very warm and warming up. The ice is shrinking! You need to keep everyone on the ice until the rescue comes.

Setup of Activity

1. Start with 8 wood blocks with round holes facing down.
2. Put a safety webbing around the blocks and cinch down as tightly as possible.
3. Push the webbing to the top of the blocks.
4. Brief the participants, give them the storyline and the rules:
 - Each participant must have at least one foot on the platform.
 - Only feet may contact the platform.
 - Participants may only stand on the platform, not on the feet of the other participants.
5. Decrease the number of blocks after each success.



Activity Variations

- Take a mousepad and instead of counting to 10, pass the mousepad around and make everyone touch it while on the platform.
- Have the participants try to “switch positions” while on the platform. For most teams, this will mean moving from one place to another. When you get to the smaller platforms, the teams will say it is impossible. However, say to them:
 - “Well if it WERE possible, how would you do it?”
 - Keep after them and push them.
 - There are many ways to ‘Switch Positions’. We have many positions. For example, my position on the movie I just watched was that I hated it! But you liked it. We can ‘Switch Positions’ on the movie. Or any other position.
 - If you keep pushing, you can get them to change their beliefs.

Discussion Questions

1. What techniques worked well?
2. What if you had twice as many people?
3. How did you feel about how close everyone had to get in the end?
4. What was the biggest problem experienced during this event?
5. Could you have done this activity without talking? What if you were blindfolded?
6. How can you apply what you learned during this activity on a daily basis?

Dynamics to Watch for

- Watch for limiting beliefs in the group. The beliefs are shattered by success. How often does that happen in life?

Tips and Tricks from Professional Facilitators

- This is a really fun activity that challenges the group to keep innovating and be creative using a limited resource.

Board Room

Watch videos, tips, suggestions and more online at www.TeamBuildingActivity.com.

Objective

Each group member to change the board they are standing on, so that they are not standing on a board with any original board members.

This activity will highlight the need for leadership, communication and interdependence.

Materials

The materials you need are included in your kit:

- 4, 7' wood planks - these 'planks' or wood boards may be slightly warped, which is completely normal. When you put them in the blocks and people stand on them, they straighten out.
- 2 to 4 Wood blocks
- Webbing

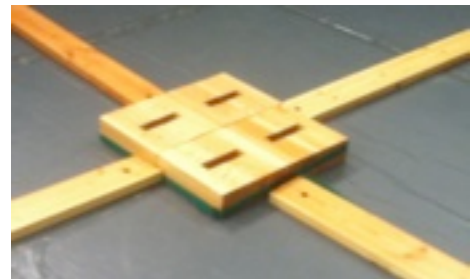


Storyline

In the fast pace world of international finance, where fortunes are made and lost in a single day, you can scarcely keep up with the mergers, corporate raiders, trading, partnering and flow of personnel in and out of the organization. Your resume is in hand, you have a plan, and you are ready for a change. You march right into The Boardroom, and demand a big raise or you're outta here. That takes about 5 seconds, and you're out on the street looking for your next position. Luckily there are at least three other organizations nearby that are looking for someone with your skills. Try to find a new position in an organization that doesn't have any of your original board members.

Setup of Activity

1. Take 2 or 4 of the wood blocks and make a square.
2. Take the webbing and put it around the blocks. Tighten the webbing so the blocks cannot separate.
3. Place a lengthwise board on each side of the square. The entire setup should look like big + with the wood block square in the middle.



4. Place the boards with 6" side up on the ground, right next to the square in the middle.
5. Ask the participants to assemble on each board, facing the middle so that each board has roughly the same number of people on each board.
6. Tell them the storyline or simply tell them what they are going to do - move to a different board while not standing on board with anyone on your board. Do this in a small gathering prior to getting on the boards.

Safety

- Watch to be sure the individuals are being careful when passing each other on the wood square in the middle.
- This is not a speed activity. Encourage participants to stay in contact with the boards, and walk slowly.

Activity Variations

- One very unique variation is to challenge the group to complete this activity without touching each other. This version still requires appropriate spotting. By using the space at the center, and shuttling participants around to various locations, it is possible to complete this challenge, even with only a single person in The Boardroom at a time.
- **CHALLENGING** - make two of the boards flat on the ground with the 6" side up and make the other two boards elevated and standing on the wooden blocks with the 2" side up. This creates a physical challenge as well as a soft skill challenge (communication, leadership, etc). In fact, to make this near impossible, tell the group that if anyone falls off the boards, they must restart the activity in their starting positions.
- To add some additional distractions to the group, but hopefully not to those spotting, try using beach balls. Any balls reaching the ground are lost, the others stay in play for as long as the activity continues.
- For a slightly more difficult variation, require participants to change boards, and to end up in a board position that is different than their original board position. If they began the activity being last in line on their board, they must end up on another board, with none of their original board members, standing in any position other than the last position in line.



Discussion Questions

1. What did you think of the activity when you started and what do you think now?
2. Did you have any idea what was going on, or did other group members tell you where to stand? Were their comments helpful?
3. How long did the planning stage and the actual activity stage of this challenge take? Did you actually take any time to plan? Did the plan work the first time or were there revisions?
4. Were there any problems that you didn't foresee and how did you overcome them?

5. What was easiest and most difficult about this activity? Why?
6. How did you see <insert topic - communication, leadership, etc> playing out in this activity?
7. Name one lesson you learned from this activity?
8. If you had to pick one part of this activity that you would take and apply to your life, what would be?

Dynamics to Watch for

- It can be very frustrating to have four separate groups all speaking at the same time. Is this what happens? Most of the time, the four boards begin working together as four separate teams. Unfortunately, when they begin moving, they realize they must work together.
- Leadership can be especially difficult in this activity. The structure of the activity does not make it easy for the group to communicate and therefore leadership is very challenging, even if a leader was selected.
 - Debrief question for leadership - Most of the time, a leader is NOT selected but leadership does occur. Tell them what you observed and ask, *"What kind of leadership was used in the activity?"* and follow up with *"Would a different kind of leadership served the group better?"*
- There is no rule that says they have to stay on the boards once they are on them. If the group were to get into a small group it would be MUCH easier to discuss and plan. However, everyone assumes it is against the rules and they must stay on the boards.
 - Debrief question if you see this: Explain and share what you observed and ask them: *"What other limiting beliefs or assumptions did you make during the activity?"*
 - A great follow up, as you are finishing up, *"What other limiting beliefs or assumptions are preventing you from being your best?"*

Tips and Tricks from Professional Facilitators

- Having approximately 3 to 5 participants on each board is about right. More also works but be careful about safety with more individuals.
- Begin this activity with participants already standing on the boards. After offering them time to plan, some groups will leave the boards so that they can plan and see the activity from a better position. Other groups stay rigidly attached to their initial positions. This makes for an interesting topic to debrief. This is also a great limiting belief discussion - see Dynamics to Watch for.

Jelly Roll

Watch videos, tips, suggestions and more online at www.TeamBuildingActivity.com.

Reference: Games Trainers Play outdoors by Gary Kroehnert

Objective

To have small teams work together on a problem-solving activity in a very fun and physical activity that can be run over and over. Leadership, communication, trust are all very present in this activity.

Materials

The materials you need are included in your kit:

- 2, 7' planks - these 'planks' or wood boards may be slightly warped, which is completely normal.
- 6, 2' x 3" pipes



Storyline

Your team has been working in the corner of a factory on a secret project. One of your team members has noticed that a vat containing a new type of highly corrosive acid has a broken pipe at the base of it.

The acid has obviously been leaking for some time, as there is a pool of acid about 30 feet wide between you and the doorway. You need to get out of the factory quickly as the acid is producing gases that are making it very hard to breath. You are unable to walk through the acid. If you touch it with any part of your body, it will dissolve you in a matter of seconds. The only equipment you have are the items in front of you. If anyone touches the acid, their team members must take them back to their original working area and place them under the special shower their. This is the only way to stop the effects of the acid. Once this is done, they will have to start the crossing again, but this time obviously be more careful. To be successful you must get all of your team members out of the factory safely.

Good Luck!

Setup of Activity

1. Select a suitable area for this activity - be careful with a hard smooth surface (gym floor), otherwise the tubes will roll too freely and participants will fall off of them. Carpet is best as they can roll easily but do not get out of control.

2. Place all gear for each team on the ground behind the starting line.
3. For the starting line, only use something you can roll over - tape (we LOVE blue painters tape) for example. If you select something substantial - a rope - the teams will have a hard time rolling over it.
4. Have the group form teams of 3-5 participants.
5. Once they have formed teams, you can nominate a leader for each team. (If you select someone fairly reserved as the leader, for any activity, it may have a huge impact on their self-image)
6. Take all teams to the starting line. Give each team their equipment.
7. Tell the teams their task is to cross an open area, using only the equipment provided, without touching the ground and as quickly as possible.

Safety

- FINGERS!! Point out, and make sure everyone is listening, that if you are in front you need to watch where you are putting your fingers when putting the pipe under the boards. Before you begin, mention this again to the participants who sit in front. Act like the stewards and stewardesses on airlines when you sit in an emergency row and ask for verbal confirmation.
 - If one finger gets between the pipe and board, there is a trip to the emergency room in your future.
- Make sure there are no sharp edges on the timbers.
- Look at the edges of the pipe for burrs or sharp edges.
- Blindfolded - watch very carefully where the groups are going and make sure they do not crash into one another or anything else. The teams can very easily and sharply turn without realizing it.

Activity Variations

- Blindfold the participants - ALL of them. This can be a very funny variation and we many times do this after several attempts/competitions. Teams can change direction very quickly so be prepared. I have had several teams who are obviously better than the others that accidentally make a 90 degree turn and are charging off in the wrong direction, but going VERY fast! And the slower team wins. Can lead to great discussion as well.
- To make this a little easier, you can allow them to touch the ground.
- Put an object in the course that each team must pick up before they can cross the finish line. You can put this object on the opposite side of the course so the teams must cross one another. This can be very fun as the teams will get in each others way.
- Stop the group halfway through the activity (especially if one group has a BIG lead) and tell them they must pick up the object and then put the object behind them near the start line. So the team in the lead has further to go. This will level the playing field and give both teams a chance.

- If you have a large group, create a tournament and a fairly short course. Let each group race a couple of times and then let the tournament begin!

Discussion Questions

1. What was most effective for the more successful teams?
2. Did you move the team members around to test out different positions or did you stick with your original positions? Why?
3. Who did what? Who took what roles?
4. How effective was your leader?
5. Do you think your team worked as well as it could have? Why?
6. What would you suggest to have the team work more effectively?
7. Do you find you need similar support at school or at home?
8. How can you apply what you learned during this activity on a daily basis?

Dynamics to Watch for

- Teams that do the same thing over and over again without changing anything. For example, one person asserts themselves in the beginning and wants to be in front but does not do well. However, no one challenges that person's desire to be in front. Why?
- Watch for taunting or teasing of groups that are less successful.

Tips and Tricks from Professional Facilitators

- Blindfolded - watch the groups very carefully to ensure they do not get too far off course and run into something.
- While this tends to be a more competitive activity between groups, there is GREAT discussion surrounding leadership, communications, beliefs, etc. AND it is an absolute blast at the same time.
- Many times we use this activity as a first in a series, if we can. It is physical, but not too physical. It is also really fun and when you can pull out great discussion, participants realize that you can learn and have fun at the same time - that there is a lesson to be learned in everything we do.

Mohawk Walk

Watch videos, tips, suggestions and more online at www.TeamBuildingActivity.com.

Objective

This is a great physical activity to challenge participants. Leadership, trust and problem solving are all outcomes from this activity.

The goal is for the group to cross, as one unit connected together, all four of the boards without falling off.

Materials

The materials you need are included in your kit:

- 4, 7' wood planks - these 'planks' or wood boards may be slightly warped, which is completely normal. When you put them in the blocks and people stand on them, they straighten out.
- 8 wooden blocks
- 8 rubber rounds
- 8, 3" wood safety dowels
- 7' wooden dowel



Setup of Activity



1. Set up four 7' boards with the 2" side up at 45 degree angles.
 - Use wooden safety dowels to prevent the boards from moving.
 - Use the rubber rounds underneath the wooden blocks to ensure the blocks do not move.

2. Brief the group about what they are doing and let them begin.
3. See the variations below for some additional ideas

Activity Variations

- Let individuals attempt this activity first and they will see how easy it is to accomplish this. After everyone has done this and they feel confident, give them the group instructions. They will be **AMAZED** at how much more difficult it is. This is a great variation to help individuals experience that working in a group takes effort and concentration. However, accomplishing tasks as a group is much more rewarding!
- Before beginning, ask the group how fast they believe they can accomplish the task. You can use the variation above with this and they will pick a fast time.
- As this is very challenging, what you can do is have the group count the number of falls they make. After you have finished, have them do it again and try to beat the number of falls. You can have them set a new goal after the first baseline run. When they get down very low, they will have a **GREAT** sense of achievement.
- After several attempts let the groups use the 7' dowel. However, the dowel can **ONLY** move forward and cannot go backward. The dowel is very helpful to help participants balance on the beams and can take a group that is struggling and help them be successful.



Discussion Questions

1. What was the biggest problem experienced during this event?
2. What did you first think of the exercise and what do you think about it now?
3. Why was it so challenging for the group?
4. What kind of support did you find was helpful during the activity?
5. Why does the dowel get so much attention?
6. What does the dowel represent in your life?
7. Do you find you need similar support at work or at home? How can you apply what you learned during this activity on a daily basis?

Dynamics to Watch for

- Watch for the group attempting the same strategy over and over without success.
- Watch for frustration with group members. Some will seem to fall more often than others. It is not necessarily that they have poor balance (although that may be true). It is more likely where they are in the group. The middle of the line is more challenging as you get pushed and pulled from both sides.

Tips and Tricks from Professional Facilitators

- This activity appears simple. And for one person it is fairly simple and easy to accomplish. However, as a group, this activity is deceptively challenging.
- Many groups will change the way each person is facing. One person facing left and the other right. This tends to balance out the entire group. If everyone is facing the same way, there seems to be a domino effect and one person will eventually fall off.

TP Shuffle

Watch videos, tips, suggestions and more online at www.TeamBuildingActivity.com.

Objective

This event is designed to get the group interacting, having fun and is traditionally an icebreaker.

Although a great icebreaker, there are great insights that are possible in the areas of:

- leadership,
- trust,
- communication and
- changing perspectives.

Any of these can be touched upon during discussion and connected back to work.

To complete the tasks the team will need to use teamwork, cooperation and creativity.

This event is also great way to get people touching each other without feeling threatened.

Materials

The materials you need are included in your kit:

- 1 to 4, 7' wood planks - these 'planks' or wood boards may be slightly warped, which is completely normal. When you put them in the blocks and people stand on them, they straighten out.
- 8 safety 3" dowels
- 8 wood blocks
- 8 rubber rounds



Setup of Activity



1. Put together 1 to 4 of the 7' boards depending upon how many people are in the group.
 - Use the rubber rounds underneath the wood blocks for safety.
2. Have the entire group stand on the "log" in random order, but all facing one end of the log. So each person should be looking at someone else's back.
3. Without turning around, team members must arrange themselves by one of the following as quickly as possible:
 - Date of Birth, month and day, NOT AGE
 - Alphabetically by middle initial
 - Hair Length
 - Color of hair, darkest to lightest
 - Furthest distance ever traveled from this location
 - Place each person was born, either in alphabetical order or by distance
 - Alphabetical order of high school mascot
 - Distance from current location to where you graduated high school.
4. If someone steps off and touches the ground, everyone starts over. See potential variations on this.

Safety

- If you feel it is necessary, stand near the team in a spotting position.
- Be sure participants don't hurt themselves or others trying to change positions.
- By design, this activity creates close proximity among the participants to encourage a small amount of trust. Be sure your group is ready for this as some may feel discomfort.

Dynamics to Watch for

- Styles of communication and how they overcome your communication challenges.
- Who shows up as the leader and how they include or exclude team members?
- How much fun they are having and who is fueling the fun.
- How the leadership of the group must change as the challenge changes.

Activity Variations

- You can select to only put the boards on the ground and not elevated.
- Blindfolds are always fun to mix it up. Make the blindfolding completely random and give them a temporary impairment that only you can take away. Blindfold and un-blindfold frequently to create a more chaotic activity that participants generally find more fun.

- Bring face masks used in hospitals and randomly silence some or all of the participants – works especially great in hospital settings.
- Another great physical impairment is to tell some or all of the participants they can now only stand on one leg. Take this away from some or all of them at will.
- If you have a large group, break them into two separate groups and have them run at the same time. Without even mentioning a 'race' or competition, they will immediately compete. However, if they actually worked together, the groups could work together and help each other rearrange themselves much more quickly because you can see more looking at the group sideways than you can looking straight ahead.
- Time – creating time pressure always creates pressure and tension (in a good way) and will strengthen reactions from the participants.
- One variation is to time them on the first try and use that time as the time to beat.
 - “Do you think you can do it faster?”

They will answer yes, of course, so then tell them you are changing how they need to reorder themselves – now instead of by hair length, by date of birth.

They will moan and/or groan, but tell them that business/life is always changing, customers/our family always want something different in the same amount of time and life is not fair!
 - Another variation is to ask them how fast they think they can accomplish the task. Check their actual time against what they thought they could do and ask for explanation (they will always miss it by A LOT).
- Square TP Shuffle - the same execution with a different set up. Instead of a single long line, create a square using the 6" up method. See below:



Tips and Tricks from our Facilitators

- This is an event that is supposed to be fun. Watch to make sure everyone is having fun. Occasionally, individuals feel uncomfortable in the beginning due to the close proximity of people they don't know. You may want to share any observations between the beginning and end of the activity.
- Try and find something unique about your group to arrange themselves by. However, try to stay away from something that elevates others in the group like seniority or may alienate participants like age.
- Use the rules as a guide and change them as necessary. It is obviously more difficult to do this task without talking but change that if it does not fit the group.

An Icebreaker:

This is a fantastic tool to get people to know a little bit more about each other than they previously knew. Use some of the more interesting personal methods to rearrange themselves.

This simple game helps humanize each individual in the room and many times sparks interesting conversations as people realize they were born near each other, etc.

The key is to start simple—i.e. hair length and then reorganize using more difficult and personal attributes.

A Communication Tool:

This is an impressive communication tool and can tell the group a great deal about how they communicate.

At the beginning, if you tell everyone to line up facing a particular direction, the natural leader will go to the front and the least likely leader will be in the back. However, if you are in the front and CANNOT turn around, you are not able to lead!

Because everyone is in a linear line, it is very difficult to communicate with someone more than a few feet in front of you. So the group tends to break down into small groups of three or four to solve their little piece of the problem and the game is solved.

This is fine, except it was left to chance. What if revenue was simply left to chance? What would happen? You simply cannot leave important communication to chance.

Is the communication within the organization also organized in a linear fashion? If so and if the group communication was disorganized, chances are, communication is being left to evolve on its own — not a good sign.

This kind of communicating is valuable and is a sign of organizational strength — everyone helps complete their piece with no need of a single leader.

However, this should be a chosen model of communication, not just happenstance.

A Trust Activity

Trust is inherent in the activity if you do not allow the participants to step off the 'log'.

This is because in order to accomplish the goal of the group, the participants will need to give up their personal space and allow others to touch them.

Allowing someone else into your personal space gives them a small amount of trust. This can be the beginning of trusting that person.

Touching is very taboo in business and this should be very carefully selected as an outcome for the activity. However, the benefits are difficult to measure when the groups accomplishes this difficult task.

A Leadership Activity

As the group goes to stand on the log, all facing one direction, one person will be in the front and one person will be in the back.

The person(s) most wanting the leadership role will go to the front. That is where leaders go.

The person(s) wanting the leadership role the least will go to the back.

However, since participants cannot turn around, the person in the front can do nothing but follow.

And the person in the back has the best view of everyone and should lead. But whether they do, or if the group lets that person is something to discuss after the event.

Changing Perspectives

Regardless of whether you are using this as an icebreaker, trust activity, leadership activity or communication tool, each person's perspective will change throughout each attempt to reorganize.

How did the changing perspective affect the group's communication, the leadership, etc?

How did those changes affect the individuals? What leadership changed when needed?

Many times we may have a great perspective on something for a short time and then lose that perspective.

- Do you (did you) continue to try and force the group to follow your lead?
- Or did the group share the leadership to accomplish the group goal?

Discussion Questions

1. How much pre-planning did you use or need?
2. Was a leader identified? If so, why?
3. Why did the activity get harder if you actually got better at the activity? (One answer is that it progressively became harder as the communication of ideas became more difficult)
4. What strategies emerged that proved helpful?
5. What new things did you learn through this activity?
6. Do you see any similarity between this activity and your interactions at work?

Traffic Jam

Watch videos, tips, suggestions and more online at www.TeamBuildingActivity.com.

Objective

Practice cycle time reduction.

To explore leadership issues within the group/team.

Communication difficulties inherent in how groups are structured (in a line).

Get group/team to think "in process."

Sensitize the team/group to communication challenges beyond structure.

Materials

The materials you need are included in your kit:

- 2 to 4, 7' Wood planks - these 'planks' or wood boards may be slightly warped, which is completely normal. When you put them in the blocks and people stand on them, they straighten out.
- 8 Wood blocks
- 8 Rubber rounds
- 8 Safety dowels
- 9 Mouse Pads



Setup of Activity



1. Set up two wood planks with the boards laying 'flat', so the 6" part of the board is up.
2. You can simply put the board on the ground, or for slightly more challenge, you can elevate the boards using the wood blocks.
 - If you do this, be sure to use the 3" wooden dowels to hold the boards in place.

- Put an additional block, or two, underneath the board in the middle to prevent 'bowing' of the wood. There will be a great deal of weight on the board.
- 3. Put a mouse pad on the floor next to the board. One mousepad for each participant, plus one extra mouse pad in the middle.
- 4. Have the participants stand on the board in front of the in the mouse pads (boxes on the pattern below) of the pattern: half of the group faces right, half of the group faces left. So the two groups are facing one another. The photo on page 24 shows the beginning step up.
- 5. Explain the task "Using only legal rules, people on the left side must end up on the right side and the people on the right must end up on the left."
 - Be very specific with the instructions and even show them how the left must end up on the right and vice versa. Ask for any questions before you begin.
- 6. After the task is completed, ask the team/group if they can complete it again in half the time.

Legal Moves:

- Only one person on each spot.
- A person may only move into in empty space in front of them.
- You may only move past one person into an open spot.
- You must stay on the board. If someone falls off, you must start over.

Illegal Moves:

- No moving backward, or turning around.
- Move around someone facing the same way you are.
- Make any move that involves two people moving at once.

If you have no legal moves left, start over.

Solution on the last page of activity information.



Activity Variations

Competition / Collaboration Variation

If you have enough people for two activities, you are presented with a unique competition / collaboration experience.

Split the group into two subgroups. Emphasize they are NOT in competition and very clearly state they can share information about how to best accomplish the task.

Regardless of your encouragement, the teams will compete.

Behavior changes depending upon the makeup of the group. However, the first group to finish will:

- Share their solution while the struggling group refuses the help, wanting to figure it out on their own.
- Laugh at the team and/or taunt them while they struggle.

Watch behavior very carefully as you may be able to use it in the debrief to illustrate how easy it is to not collaborate – for whatever reason!

A Second Time Through

If the team is particularly adept at this exercise and has successfully completed the task, ask them to complete the task while holding their breath. Allow them to appoint a coach who may breathe while assisting the team.

Learning Points:

- Teamwork and communication are essential to understanding complex processes.
- Teams can make significant process improvements in a short period of time by drawing on the expertise of all the team members.

More, or less, than 8

If you have more than 8, you have a couple of options:

- You can split them up into smaller groups. You **DO NOT** need to have 8. Any other even number will work. So, both 4 and 6 will work well. Then have them ‘collaborate’ like above. When you split them up, you will need to get more ‘mouse pads’. I almost always take a roll of blue painters tape with me. It is very easy to create boxes with it and it leaves no residue behind on gym floors or
- Increase the ‘mouse pads’. You can do this using blue painters tape, or just about any object. Just make sure there is one object per person and an open spot in the center. So, if you have 16, you need 17 objects.

Safety

There are two safety issues to take into consideration here:

Physical Safety

If you are using the boards elevated, be sure to use the locking 3” dowels. Without these, the boards may slip.

If you are using 2” side up, be very careful and ask several times if participant’s feet are hurting. They tend to hurt after prolonged time on the 2” side.

Emotional Safety

Equally important to physical safety is emotional safety. Most frequently, this involves overweight participants. If there is one or more people who are significantly overweight, use the 6” side up and also consider modifying stepping off the plank to accommodate them. You do not want them to feel uncomfortable in a proximity activity like this.

Discussion Questions

1. What was your first thought about this event and what do you think about it now?
2. What was the problem? How did you break it down?
3. How effective was the team at solving this problem? Why or why not?
4. What kind of leadership emerged?
5. If you were frustrated, what caused it and how did you overcome it?
6. Did the team stop to plan any strategy before attempting the task? Why or why not? Would that have helped? Do you see this same pattern at work, where we jump in too quickly without planning?
7. What lessons have you learned that can you apply to life?

Tips and Tricks

- This activity is challenging in it's structure. Each person can only see right next to them.
- You can also begin the group facing toward you and the mouse pads. They will inevitably turn and face the oncoming group to get around each other.
- You can be lax with the rule about falling off or stepping off the boards.
- I like to set this up with two, or more, teams. When you do that, inevitably they compete - See Variations #1.
 - The reality is that they can see each other much better than they can see themselves. If they collaborate, both teams can accomplish the task more quickly than if they run it individually. At least the first time.
- You DO NOT need the wood planks to run this activity. You can simply use the mouse pads themselves.
- Carry a roll of blue painters tape with you AT ALL TIMES. It is extremely handy and can be used for all kinds of things (see Variations #3 above, for example)
- If you want to make this NEAR IMPOSSIBLE, set up the boards so the participants are walking on the 2" side instead of the 6" side. This makes balance an extreme challenge. I have never had a group complete this without falling off. It can be done, but they give up and quit before the achieve success.

Dynamics to Watch for

- The group attempting the same idea over and over without really trying anything new.
- Groups will begin unorganized with no plan and will communicate poorly, but eventually a player will lead the team to the solution. Many times, this is not the 'leader', or manager, in the group. Asking how and why that occurred may be important during the debrief - shared leadership?

- Stay out of the critical thinking process, unless the team has no cooperation or direction.
- Make note of similarities between the planning and execution compared to scenarios that typically occurs for the group.

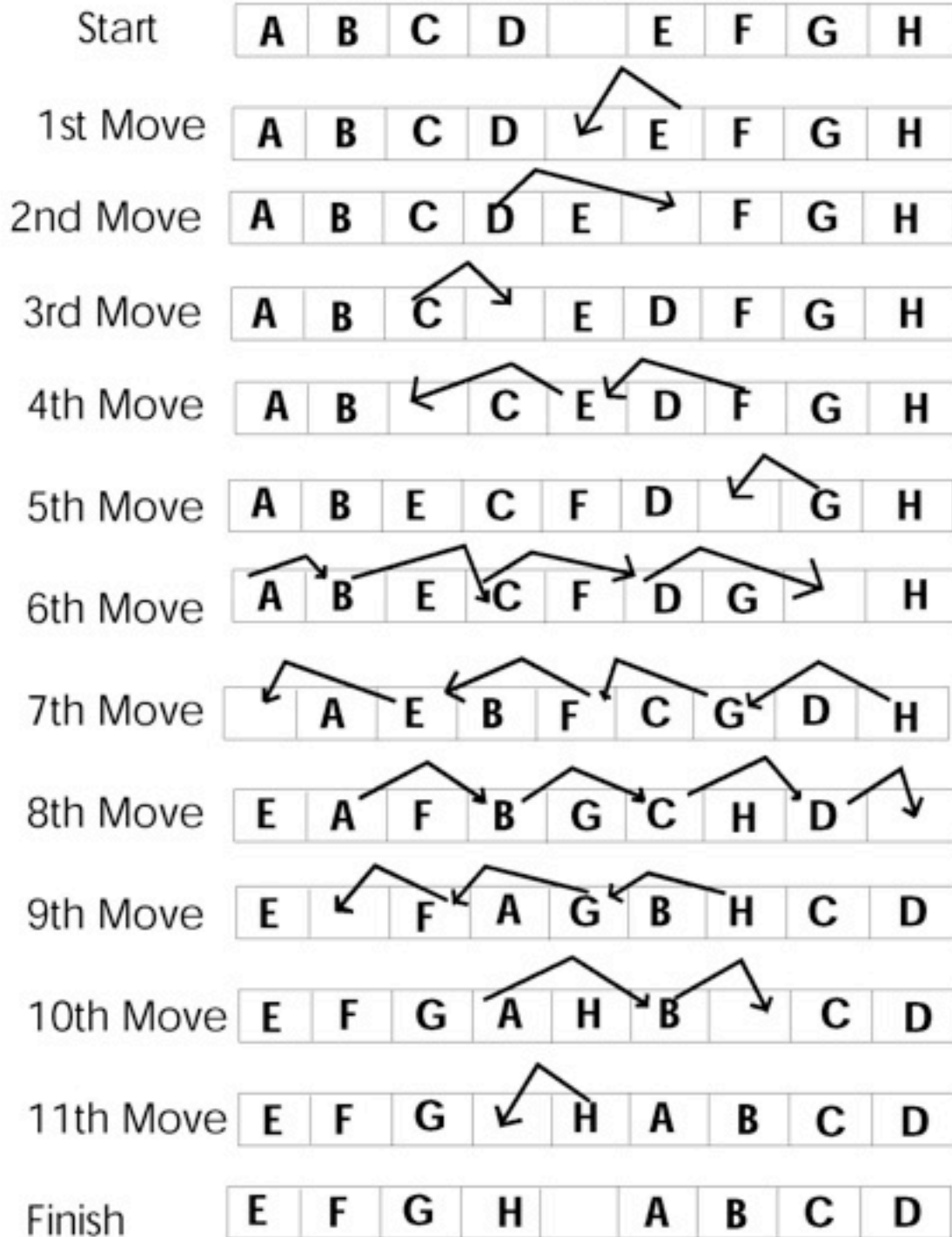
Tips and Tricks from Professional Facilitators

From time to time, a group will have an incredibly hard time 'getting' this exercise. Depending upon time constraints, you may want to let them go and see measure their level of commitment, or you can give them hints on how to solve it.

Notice the pattern L side- 1 move , R side-2 moves, L side-3 moves, R side 4 moves, L side 4 moves, R side 4 moves, L side 3 moves, R side 2 moves, L side 1 move.

If there is less than eight players to a group, use an inanimate object in the game to represent a player.

TRAFFIC JAM ANSWER KEY



Trust Walk

Watch videos, tips, suggestions and more online at www.TeamBuildingActivity.com.

Objective

This is one of the most powerful and, ironically, one of the simplest events we offer. The Trust Walk is about leading, following and communication. Many leadership styles emerge during this event. Some find it difficult to be responsible for another person's safety and others find it exhilarating.

To trust or give up control can be very hard for some people. Whatever the experience, the Trust Walk is a powerful learning opportunity.



Materials

The materials you need are included in your kit:

- Enough blindfolds for half the group.

Storyline

You have lost your sight in a plane crash. It is up to one of your fellow passengers to lead you to safety. The problem is your fellow partner has lost their speech and hearing. You must find other ways to communicate if either of you are to survive.

Setup of Activity

1. Describe the boundaries to all members of the team.
2. Have them find a partner.
3. One partner should put a blindfold on the other (this may not be the person they will lead).
4. **STRESS THE IMPORTANCE OF SAFETY AND CARE FOR THE PERSON BLINDFOLDED.** Remind team members it is their choice at what level they participate, and their choice will be positively supported. Specifically state that they may choose not to participate.
5. Create a mood of seriousness and have them take a deep breath. After the deep breath, there is to be no more talking.



6. Encourage them to resist the temptation to speak.
7. Challenge them to create a powerful level of communication without using their voices.
8. The sighted leader should give the blindfolded person as many different experiences as possible (a new touch, sound, smell, feeling, taste, etc).
9. Encourage safe creativity.
10. At this point, have the leaders circle around the blindfolded people. Have them rotate around the group clockwise. When you say, 'Stop', they are to take one of the blindfolded people and begin leading them around.
11. The experience should be at least five minutes long and can be as long as 30 minutes per person.
12. Silently gather them back together and have the leaders remove the blindfolds at the same time. Give them one minute to talk about the experience together and have a short group debrief.
13. Switch the blindfolds.
14. After the second group goes, bring everyone back together and have a final debrief of the entire experience.

Activity Variations

- Have most of the team members blindfolded and only one person leading.
- You may have the entire team choose a destination and try to get to it with all of them blindfolded. You will need to be the safety for the blindfolded group.
- Do not allow touching. This will ensure more verbal communication versus leading them around by the arm.

Discussion Questions

1. Ask each person to share something they appreciated about the person they led or the person leading them.
2. How did you overcome the challenges you encountered and did you reach a level of complete trust?
3. How did it feel being a leader or a follower?
4. What can you learn from this experience?
5. Are there times (at work) when you must absolutely trust, put blind faith, in someone else? How does that feel?
6. How can we take what we have learned back to work and our daily lives?

Be sure to let everyone carry the discussion. Once someone makes a statement, there may be silence. If this happens, ask if anyone else agrees with the statement and/or ask for feedback on the statement.

Dynamics to Watch for

- Creative ways of leading and following. Be sure to share your observations of the creativity in the debrief, if you see any. If you do not, you may want to ask if anyone saw or experienced some creative leading and following.
- People who are reluctant to trust.
- Careless or insensitive people.
- Unsafe activity.

Tips and Tricks from Professional Facilitators

Communication Activity:

These focus more on communication than leadership, but communication is a large part of the type of leader each person is, so it may fit very well into your plans. Also, this allows you to use the exercise more than once.

These Variations are best used after you have already run the original Trust Walk, although it is not absolutely necessary.

1. Let them speak, but set up an obstacle course that they must guide their partner through, around, under, etc. Combine this with not allowing them to speak and you have a very interesting activity.
2. For a loud, fun yet powerful event, create a circle and have the obstacle course inside the circle. If you are in a room, instruct the non-blindfolded partner that they must be touching a wall at all times. This will create a good space.
 - a. The partner is allowed to communicate from outside the circle while the blindfolded partner goes into the center.
 - b. If you send all pairs into the circle at the same time, you create absolute mayhem! The pairs do not strategize how to recognize instructions from the partner – everyone is yelling into the center.
 - c. This is very fun! However, be sure to let them choose to participate after you have told them what they will be doing.
 - d. Make sure everyone is safe!

Safety

- Make sure a sighted person is leading a blindfolded person.
- Look for dangerous obstacles, holes, etc.
- Warn the leaders of potential hazards.
- It may be necessary for you to “spot” at certain times.
- Point out poison oak/ivy, if you are outside.
- Be sure you feel good about each leader’s ability to take care of their partner
- No climbing.

Wild Woosey

Watch videos, tips, suggestions and more online at www.TeamBuildingActivity.com.

Objective

Work dependently with a partner in which each must trust the other explicitly.

Cross the 'deep v' while maintaining contact with your partner.

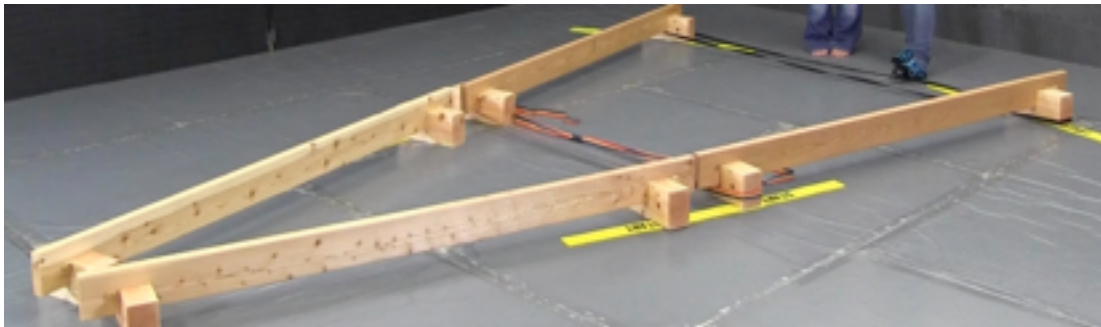
Materials

The materials you need are included in your kit:

- 4, 7' wood planks - these 'planks' or wood boards may be slightly warped, which is completely normal. When you put them in the blocks and people stand on them, they straighten out.
- 8 wood blocks
- 8, 3" dowels
- 8 rubber rounds
- 4 safety webbing straps



Setup of Activity



There is one basic setup for the activity with minor variations.

1. Set up a 'V' using all four of the 7' boards with the 2" side facing up. One end of the boards will be next to each other and one end of the boards will be roughly 9' apart.
 - Be sure to use safety dowels.
 - Be sure to use the rubber rounds underneath the wooden blocks to ensure the blocks will not move.

- Use the safety webbing straps to ensure the two sets of boards do not move from each other. The straps are adjustable to make the activity easier or harder. The lengths of the webbing are specific to how far apart the boards are. Use them in this order:
 - i. Purple - where the two sets of boards connect - the bottom of the 'V'. Connect the two wooden blocks together and cinch down tight.
 - ii. Green - Connect the next two blocks at the end of the first boards.
 - iii. Red - Connect the blocks at the next set of boards.
 - iv. Black - Connect the blocks at the end of the second set of boards.



2. Brief the participants and tell them what they are doing.
3. Have participants get into a "turtle" position between the boards, in the middle of the 'V' as a protection for the participants, should they fall. See photo below.



Safety

1. Be VERY careful in setting up this activity. Go slow and make sure everything is perfect.
2. Test the activity prior to putting anyone on it.
3. This is a trust activity! Be serious with the participants and make sure they are taking safety seriously. It is all fun and games until someone gets hurt.
4. Watch for physical AND emotional safety. Emotional safety is very real - teasing, outright making fun of someone, etc are all elements that compromise emotional safety and destroy trust.
5. There are several ways a person can sabotage and/or ruin the activity:
 - Pull your partner toward you knock them off the board.

- Drop your hands intentionally so the partner falls forward
- One partner goes too fast, many times on purpose.

Activity Variations

- The major variation for this activity is to increase the width of the 'V'. The more you separate the boards of the 'V', the more challenging the activity becomes. Also, the more you have to trust and communicate with your partner.
- Another great variation is to switch partners. It is possible to have partners that are wildly different and yet can accomplish this task.

Discussion Questions

1. How did your group decide on the technique they were going to use?
2. Was this technique useful for keeping the group in step with each other? Did your group experience breakdown? What happened then?
3. Did your group begin and end with the same technique? Are there any other techniques?
4. What are situations in which groups must work in synchronization? How does unity and synchronization, or lack thereof, change the group's performance?
5. What lessons can you take away from this activity?



Dynamics to Watch for in the Group and Individuals

Boredom can set in for the people in the middle of the 'V', so be sure to keep it moving fast so many participants can go through the activity multiple times with different partners.

Trust will increase as they become more familiar with the activity itself. Great debrief question:

- Does that mean the trust in each other increased, or that you trusted the activity more? Explain your answer.

Tips and Tricks from Professional Facilitators

This is a great activity to do after another activity that requires all the boards to be set up - Mohawk Walk, for example - as you already have everything ready to go and simply need to connect the safety webbing. Also, trust activities are better to do after a small amount of trust is given.

Support

Call Us at 800-513-8759!

We are absolutely happy to help you with any questions you might have with your materials or activities.

www.TeambuildingActivity.com

Visit our website for additional support, videos , variations and more our launch will be on January 1, 2013!

As part of your purchase, you will have access to the information for the activities included in this guide. You will also have access to facilitator information which will help you execute these activities better.

